5E LESSON PLAN: WEEK 11 – MISS PATTERSON

- **Institution:** Happy Grove High School
- **Grade Level:** Grade 8
- **Class:** 8^3
- **Subject:** English Literature
- **Date:** November 23, 2026
- **Duration:** 60 minutes
- **NSC Learning Strand:** Reading for Meaning and Enjoyment (Comprehension & Literature); Communication (Writing) – essay writing
- **NSC Attainment Target:** Write a structured comparative essay that responds to a literary question, using evidence from a novel and a poem, clear paragraphing and linking words.
- **Topic:** Essay Writing – Planning and Writing a Comparison Essay (My Father, Sun-Sun Johnson and "My Parents")
- **Previous Knowledge:** In Week 9, students studied imagery and theme in "My Parents", including how the parents keep their child away from the rough children. In Week 10, they mapped the whole plot of My Father, Sun-Sun Johnson on Freytag's Pyramid and wrote a PEE paragraph on how Sun-Sun changes.

Key Vocabulary

Key Vocabulary (word wall)

Essay: a piece of writing of several paragraphs that answers one question

Introduction: the first paragraph; it names the texts and answers the question in one sentence

Thesis: the one sentence that gives your answer to the question

Body paragraph: a PEE paragraph that gives one point with evidence

Conclusion: the last paragraph; it sums up your answer without new points

Compare: show how two things are alike

Contrast: show how two things are different

Linking words: words that join ideas, e.g. both, similarly (alike); however, whereas (different)

Learning Objectives

By the end of the lesson:

Cognitive

1. After the Explain phase, students will identify the four parts of a comparison essay (introduction, similarity paragraph, difference paragraph, conclusion), with all four correct.
2. Using the essay plan, students will write a comparison essay of at least four paragraphs answering the Part D question, with one similarity and one difference supported by evidence from both texts.

Affective

3. During peer review, students will give their partner one specific star and one specific wish based on the rubric.

Psychomotor

4. Using the cut-up model essay, students will arrange the four paragraphs in the correct order and circle at least four linking words.

Learning Domains

- **Cognitive:** Identify essay structure; plan and write a comparison essay with evidence.
- **Affective:** Give and receive feedback respectfully.
- **Psychomotor:** Sequence paragraph strips; write the essay.

Learning Styles

- **Visual:** Essay structure chart and linking-word bank on the whiteboard and PowerPoint.
- **Auditory:** Group discussion, teacher think-aloud while planning.
- **Kinaesthetic:** Ordering paragraph strips; writing.

Resources

- The Part D question on a PowerPoint slide (in Engage below)
- KWL charts (in Engage below)
- Envelopes with the cut-up model essay and group role slips (in Explore below)
- Essay structure chart and linking-word bank (in Explain below)
- Essay plan frame, students' Week 9 notes on the poem and Week 10 PEE paragraph, the poem and class copies of the novel (in Elaborate below)
- Peer-review rubric, exit tickets and traffic-light slips (in Elaborate and Evaluate below)
- PowerPoint and whiteboard

NSC Major Objectives (Curriculum Alignment)

- Compare and contrast the elements and authors of various literary genres (e.g. short story, novel, drama, fable, fantasy, biography, documentary, poetry, and science-fiction). *(Reading for Meaning and Enjoyment (Comprehension & Literature) – Term 1, Unit 1). Checked by: Comparison essay (one similarity and one difference between the novel and the poem).*
- Determine a central idea of a text and analyse its development over the course of the text, including its relationship to supporting ideas. *(Reading for Meaning and Enjoyment (Comprehension & Literature) – Term 1, Unit 1). Checked by: Essay body paragraphs and Exit Ticket Q3 (thesis linked to the texts).*

A Communication (Writing) objective on essay writing can be added from the Grade 8 page of the curriculum book.

Instructional Strategies

- **KWL Chart:** Engage – what students know and want to know about writing an essay.
- **Command-Word Analysis:** Engage – unpacking the Part D question.

- **Sequencing with Role Slips:** Explore – groups put a cut-up model essay in order.
- **Teacher Think-Aloud:** Explain – planning the essay on the whiteboard.
- **Higher-Order Questioning:** Explain – analyse, compare, evaluate and create questions.
- **Scaffolded Writing (essay plan frame):** Elaborate – students build their essay from their PEE paragraphs.
- **Differentiated Instruction:** Elaborate – sentence-starter frame and extension task.
- **Peer Assessment with the Rubric (Star and Wish):** Elaborate – partners mark each other's essay.
- **Traffic-Light Self-Assessment and Exit Ticket:** Evaluate – individual check on essay structure.

Subject Integration

- **Social Studies (Explain):** Students discuss different ways parents raise children (giving freedom or being protective) and how each affects a child, linking to the family as a social institution.
- **Mathematics (Elaborate):** Students convert their peer-review mark out of 30 into a percentage.

Classroom Organization and Management

- **Classroom layout and safety:** Desks are arranged in groups of four for the sequencing task, then in pairs for writing and peer review. Bags hang on the backs of chairs and walkways are kept clear so the teacher can reach every group.
- **Materials:** Cards, strips and worksheets are prepared in labelled envelopes before the lesson, so no time is lost handing them out.
- **Group roles:** For group tasks, each member receives a role slip (see the slips in the procedure) so every student knows exactly what to do and no one is left out.
- **Transitions:** The teacher uses the call-and-response "Class, class!" / "Yes, yes!" as an attention signal, and a visible timer shows how long each phase lasts.
- **Positive reinforcement:** Specific verbal praise, group points on the board, and good work displayed on the word wall.
- **Expectations:** Listen when others speak, respect every answer, share tasks fairly, and handle materials carefully.

Accommodations (Inclusion)

- **Reading difficulties:** Large-print cards and a reading partner; the teacher reads text aloud on request.
- **Writing difficulties:** Students may answer orally, point to the correct card, or have a peer scribe one answer.
- **Attention or vision needs:** Preferential seating near the board and the teacher.
- **Absent students:** Students who miss the lesson (for example, for sports) receive the notes and classwork as a catch-up pack.

Backup Plan (No Technology)

- **If there is no electricity, internet or projector:** The Part D question, essay structure chart and linking-word bank are written on the whiteboard or chart paper; the model essay, plan frame and rubric are printed.

5E PROCEDURE

1. ENGAGEMENT (8 minutes)

- **Activating Prior Knowledge:** The teacher asks: "What do the letters in PEE stand for? What did you write about in your last two paragraphs?" Students fill in the K and W columns of their KWL chart on writing an essay.

KWL Chart: Writing a Comparison Essay (one per student)

K – What I Know	W – What I Want to Know	L – What I Learned
e.g. A PEE paragraph has a point, evidence and an explanation.	*e.g. How do I start an essay?*	*(Completed in Evaluate)*

- **Student Learning Activity:** Students will read the Part D exam question on the PowerPoint slide, underline the command words in their copy, and say what the question is asking them to do.

Exam Question (Part D)

Compare and contrast the way Sun-Sun Johnson treats his son Rami with the way the parents in "My Parents" treat their child. Discuss at least ONE similarity and ONE difference.

- **Teacher Facilitation:** The teacher will show the question and guide students to the command words. The teacher will ask:
- Which words tell you what to do? (Compare and contrast; Discuss)
- How many similarities and differences must you give? (At least one of each.)
- Which two texts must you use? (The novel and the poem.)
- **Technology (in class):** The Part D question is shown on a PowerPoint slide with the command words in bold.
- **Formative Check:** Students hold up fingers: "How many texts must you write about?" (Two.)

(Visual & Auditory)

2. EXPLORATION (12 minutes)

- **Student Learning Activity:** Students will work in groups of four. They open the envelope with a short model essay cut into four paragraphs (A–D), put the paragraphs in order, label

each one (introduction, similarity, difference, conclusion) and circle the linking words in pen.

Model Essay Strips (print and cut; one set per group, mixed up)

Question: Compare and contrast Robin Hill and River Bottom in My Father, Sun-Sun Johnson.

	Paragraph
A	In My Father, Sun-Sun Johnson, Rami lives in two very different homes: Robin Hill and River Bottom. Both places matter to him, but they are very different in wealth and comfort.
B	One similarity is that both are homes Rami shares with his father. At Robin Hill they live together after Ma leaves, and at River Bottom they cook, farm and work side by side. Similarly, in both homes Rami feels that he belongs with Father: "You and me, Rami."
C	However, Robin Hill is a grand house with a maid and gas lamps, whereas River Bottom is a small cabin three miles from Robin Hill. This shows that the family has gone from wealth to having very little.
D	In conclusion, Robin Hill and River Bottom are both homes where Rami stands by his father, but one is rich and the other is poor. The contrast shows that loyalty matters more to Rami than money.

Group Role Slips (cut out; give one slip to each group member)

✂️ **Reader**
Read each paragraph strip aloud to the group.

✂️ **Arranger**
Place the strips in order once the group agrees.

✂️ **Checker**
Circle the linking words in pen and check the labels.

✂️ **Reporter**
Tell the class your order and how you knew which paragraph came first.

Teacher Answers: Model Essay

Order: A (introduction), B (similarity), C (difference), D (conclusion). Linking words: both, similarly, however, whereas, in conclusion.

- **Teacher Facilitation:** The teacher will hand out the envelopes and role slips, circulate, and ask groups how they knew which paragraph was the introduction and which was the conclusion.
- **Formative Check:** Reporters share their order; the class agrees or corrects it.
- **Feedback:** The teacher gives specific feedback, e.g. "Yes, C is the difference paragraph. Which word told you? (However.)"

(Kinaesthetic & Auditory)

3. EXPLANATION (12 minutes)

- **Student Learning Activity:** Students will copy the essay structure chart and linking-word bank, then watch the teacher plan the Part D essay aloud on the whiteboard.

Essay Structure (students copy into notebooks)

Paragraph	What goes in it
1. Introduction	Name both texts and their writers. Write your thesis: one sentence that answers the question.
2. Similarity (PEE)	Point: one way they are alike. Evidence from the novel AND the poem. Explain.
3. Difference (PEE)	Point: one way they are different. Evidence from the novel AND the poem. Explain.
4. Conclusion	Sum up your answer in one or two sentences. No new evidence.

Linking-Word Bank

To show they are alike: both, similarly, likewise, also, in the same way

To show they are different: however, whereas, while, unlike, on the other hand

To end: in conclusion, overall, to sum up

- **Teacher Facilitation:** The teacher will think aloud while planning the essay on the whiteboard: "My similarity is that both… My difference is that Sun-Sun… whereas the parents in the poem…" The teacher shows where their Week 9 poem notes and Week 10 paragraph fit.
- **Subject Integration (Social Studies):** The teacher asks students to name different ways parents raise children (giving freedom or being protective) and how each might affect a child, linking to the family as a social institution.

Higher-Order Questions (whole-class discussion)

1. Analyse: Why does a comparison essay need both a similarity and a difference?
2. Compare: How is a body paragraph in this essay different from the PEE paragraphs you wrote before?
3. Evaluate: Is it better to write about one text at a time or both texts in every paragraph? Why?
4. Create: Write a thesis sentence for the Part D question.

Guide answers: the question asks for both, and the reader sees the full picture; it uses evidence from two texts, not one; both texts in every paragraph keeps the comparison clear; accept any thesis that names both texts and answers the question.

- **Technology (in class):** The essay structure chart and linking-word bank are shown on a PowerPoint slide and stay up while students write.

- **Formative Check:** The teacher points to each row of the chart; students say what goes in that paragraph chorally.

(Visual & Auditory)

4. ELABORATION (20 minutes)

- **Student Learning Activity:** Students will complete the essay plan frame, then write their essay in their notebooks, using their Week 9 notes on the poem and their Week 10 PEE paragraph. They finish the essay for homework if needed.

Essay Plan Frame (one per student)

Paragraph	My notes
1. Introduction (thesis)	
2. Similarity: novel	
2. Similarity: poem	
3. Difference: novel	
3. Difference: poem	
4. Conclusion	

Sentence starters: Both Sun-Sun and the parents in "My Parents"… For example, in Chapter… In the poem… However, Sun-Sun… whereas the parents… In conclusion…

Teacher Answers: Points Students May Use

Similarity: both Sun-Sun and the parents in the poem love their child and want to protect him.

Differences: Sun-Sun gives Rami freedom, trusts him and lets him choose where to live (Chapter 1), whereas the parents in the poem keep their child away from the rough children; Sun-Sun teaches Rami to work and be independent at River Bottom, while the child in the poem is sheltered and lonely.

Possible thesis: Both Sun-Sun and the parents in "My Parents" love their child, but Sun-Sun gives Rami freedom while the parents in the poem keep their child apart.

- **Differentiation Support:** Supported students use the sentence starters and write the introduction and one body paragraph in class.
- **Differentiation Extension:** Extended students add a second difference paragraph and end their conclusion with what both texts teach about growing up.

- **Teacher Facilitation:** The teacher will circulate and conference with students, checking that each body paragraph has evidence from both texts.
- **Peer Assessment:** Partners swap essays and mark them with the peer-review rubric below, giving one star and one wish.

Peer-Review Rubric (the same as the exam, 30 marks)

Criteria	What to look for	Marks
Content	One clear similarity and one clear difference, with accurate details from both texts	/12
Evidence	Quotations or details from the novel and the poem, explained	/8
Organisation	Introduction, body paragraphs and conclusion; linking words	/6
Language	Standard Jamaican English; spelling, grammar and punctuation	/4
Total		**/30**

Star (something done well): _____

Wish (one thing to improve): _____

- **Subject Integration (Mathematics):** Students convert their peer-review mark out of 30 into a percentage.
- **Numeracy Link:** e.g. 21 out of 30 = 21 ÷ 30 × 100 = 70%.
- **Feedback:** The teacher gives specific feedback, e.g. "Your similarity paragraph uses both texts. In your difference paragraph, add a detail from the poem after 'whereas'."

(Visual & Kinaesthetic)

5. EVALUATION (8 minutes)

- **Student Learning Activity:** Students will complete the exit ticket on their own, then fill in the L column of the KWL chart and the traffic-light self-assessment.
- **Teacher Facilitation:** The teacher will collect the exit tickets and remind students to bring their finished essays next week.

Exit Ticket

1. What two things go in an introduction?
2. Write one linking word for a similarity and one for a difference.
3. Write your thesis sentence for the Part D question.

Teacher Answers: Exit Ticket

1. The names of both texts (and writers) and the thesis. 2. e.g. both / similarly; however / whereas. 3. Accept any sentence that names both texts and answers the question.

- **Self-Assessment:** Students tick one box for each statement.

Traffic-Light Self-Assessment (students tick one colour for each statement)

I can…	Green	Yellow	Red
name the four parts of a comparison essay	☐	☐	☐
use linking words to show alike and different	☐	☐	☐
use evidence from both texts	☐	☐	☐

Green = I can do this on my own. Yellow = I need a little more practice. Red = I need help.

- **Closure:** One student completes the sentence aloud: "A comparison essay needs…"
- **Positive Reinforcement:** The teacher praises students who used evidence from both texts and helpful peer feedback, and awards class points.

(Visual & Auditory)

Total: 8 + 12 + 12 + 20 + 8 = 60 minutes

Homework / Extension Assignment

Task: Finish your Part D essay (at least four paragraphs), using your partner's wish to improve it. Bring it next week.

Grading Criteria (30 marks, the same as the exam)

Criteria	What is expected	Marks
Content	One clear similarity and one clear difference, with accurate details from both texts	12
Evidence	Quotations or details from the novel and the poem, explained	8
Organisation	Introduction, body paragraphs and conclusion; linking words	6
Language	Standard Jamaican English; correct spelling, grammar and punctuation	4
Total		**30**

Technology Integration (Homework & Practice)

- **Google Classroom:** Post the essay structure chart, the linking-word bank and the rubric. Students may type and submit their essay.
- **Quizizz:** Assign an optional practice quiz on essay parts and linking words.

Assessment Summary

Type	What is assessed
Diagnostic	KWL chart (K and W); command-word discussion of the Part D question.
Formative	Model-essay sequencing with Reporter feedback; choral check; essay with peer rubric.
Summative	Exit ticket; Part D essay homework (30 marks).

Success Criteria

Students are successful when they can write a four-paragraph comparison essay with a thesis, one similarity and one difference supported by evidence from both texts, and a conclusion.

Link to Previous and Next Lesson

- **Previous:** Week 10 – Plot structure on Freytag's Pyramid and the PEE paragraph on how Sun-Sun changes.
- **Next:** Week 12 – Timed essay practice and revision for the end-of-term exam.

APA References

- Ministry of Education, Youth and Information. (2018). *National Standards Curriculum: Language and Literature Grades 7–9*. Kingston, Jamaica: MoEYI.
- Ministry of Education, Skills, Youth and Information. (n.d.). *Curriculum analysis: Essential objectives & content focus – NSC Grades 7–9* (2nd ed.). Kingston, Jamaica.
- Palmer, C. E. (1974). *My father, Sun-Sun Johnson*. Macmillan Caribbean.
- Spender, S. (1985). *Collected poems 1928–1985*. Faber & Faber.

Lesson Evaluation (complete after teaching)

What went well:

_____

_____

What to improve:

_____

_____

Students who need follow-up:

_____

SAMPLE ESSAY (COMPLETED): PART D, QUESTION 7

For the teacher to read aloud or display after students have written their own essays. Marked against the exam rubric: a high-scoring answer.

Question 7

Compare and contrast the way Sun-Sun Johnson treats his son Rami with the way the parents in "My Parents" treat their child. Discuss at least ONE similarity and ONE difference.

Sample Essay

Introduction

In the novel My Father, Sun-Sun Johnson by C. Everard Palmer and the poem "My Parents" by Stephen Spender, parents try to do what is best for a child. Both Sun-Sun and the parents in the poem love their child and want to protect him. However, Sun-Sun gives Rami freedom and trust, whereas the parents in the poem keep their child away from other children, and this leaves him lonely.

Similarity

One similarity is that both Sun-Sun and the parents in the poem care about their child's safety and wellbeing. In Chapter 1, before Rami chooses where to live, Sun-Sun warns him honestly about the hard life at River Bottom: the cooking, the long walk to school and the loneliness. He wants Rami to understand what he is choosing. Similarly, the parents in "My Parents" keep their son away from the rough children who throw "words like stones." This shows that in both texts the parents act out of love and want to shield their child from harm.

Difference 1

However, Sun-Sun gives Rami freedom, whereas the parents in the poem shelter their child. Sun-Sun lets Rami decide where to live, consults him ("Right, Rami?" in Chapter 3), and lets him sell his own goats at the market in Chapter 5. Rami says that being consulted made him "feel like a man." In contrast, the speaker in the poem is not allowed to play with the other children and can only watch them run, climb and play. This difference shows that Sun-Sun trusts his son to make his own choices, while the parents in the poem make the choice for him.

Difference 2

Because they are raised differently, the two children also turn out differently. Rami grows into a confident and independent young man. By Chapter 11 he is seventeen, leaves school to run the store and becomes the head of the family. On the other hand, the speaker in the poem is fearful and lonely. He is mocked by the children, pretends to smile, and longs to forgive them and be their friend. This suggests that too much protection can keep a child from growing up, while freedom and responsibility help a child become strong.

Conclusion

In conclusion, Sun-Sun and the parents in "My Parents" both love their child and want to protect him. However, Sun-Sun gives Rami trust and freedom, and Rami grows into a man, whereas the parents in the poem shelter their son, and he is left lonely and afraid. Together, the two texts show that the way parents raise a child can shape the kind of person he becomes.

Why This Essay Scores Well (teacher notes)

- **Content (12):** one clear similarity (love and protection) and two clear differences (freedom vs. sheltering; confident vs. lonely child).
- **Evidence (8):** details and short quotations from both texts, each followed by "This shows…" or "This suggests…".
- **Organisation (6):** introduction with a thesis, three body paragraphs and a conclusion; linking words: both, similarly, however, whereas, in contrast, on the other hand, in conclusion.
- **Language (4):** Standard Jamaican English, complete sentences, correct punctuation.